



**OBSTETRICS AND GYNAECOLOGY  
CLINICAL PRACTICE GUIDELINE**

# Discomforts in Pregnancy: Common

|                       |                                                                                                    |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Scope (Staff):</b> | WNHS Obstetrics and Gynaecology Directorate staff                                                  |
| <b>Scope (Area):</b>  | Obstetrics and Gynaecology Directorate clinical areas at KEMH, OPH and Community Midwifery Program |

**This document should be read in conjunction with this [Disclaimer](#)**

The Women and Newborn Health Service (WNHS) endorses the following document as sources of antenatal care information and guidance:

- Living Evidence for Australian Pregnancy and Postnatal Care: [Australian Pregnancy Care Guidelines \(external website\)](#) (Health Professional information)

**The National Pregnancy Care Guidelines-** Contains background, recommendations, and practice points within its 'common conditions in pregnancy' chapter, including:

- Carpal tunnel syndrome
- Constipation
- Haemorrhoids
- Nausea and vomiting
- Reflux / heartburn
- Pelvic girdle pain
- Varicose veins

**Patient information** – Refer to [WNHS Pregnancy, Birth and your Baby](#) book.



## References and resources

Living Evidence for Australian Pregnancy and Postnatal Care (LEAPP) (Ed.). Australian Pregnancy Care Guidelines (2024). Australian Living Evidence Collaboration [ALEC]. Melbourne VIC. Available from [https://files.magicapp.org/guideline/3aa6b881-4be5-4806-bb3e-e7c53b5b0bbf/published\\_guideline\\_7933-2\\_0.pdf](https://files.magicapp.org/guideline/3aa6b881-4be5-4806-bb3e-e7c53b5b0bbf/published_guideline_7933-2_0.pdf)

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|------------|
| Keywords:                                                                                                                                                      | minor discomforts in pregnancy, reflux in pregnancy, heartburn in pregnancy, varicose veins in pregnancy, leg oedema, haemorrhoids, pregnancy nausea, vaginal discharge in pregnancy, pelvic pain in pregnancy, low back pain in pregnancy, carpal tunnel syndrome in pregnancy, leg cramps in pregnancy |                   |            |
| Document owner:                                                                                                                                                | Obstetrics and Gynaecology Directorate                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                   |            |
| Author / Reviewer:                                                                                                                                             | Nurse Midwife Codirector OGD; Coordinator of Midwifery (Outpatient portfolio;                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                   |            |
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| Reviewed dates:<br>(since Nov 2015)                                                                                                                            | ; Nov 2015; Aug 2023 (minor amend), Aug 2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Next review date: | Aug 2028   |
| Endorsed by:                                                                                                                                                   | Midwifery and Obstetrics Clinical Practice Outcomes Committee                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Date:             | 20/08/2025 |
| NSQHS Standards<br>(v2) applicable:                                                                                                                            |  1: Clinical Governance                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                   |            |
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## Version history

| Date              | Summary                                                                                                                |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mar 2001          | First version. Original titled as B1.2 'Minor Symptoms or Disorders in Pregnancy'                                      |
| Prior to Aug 2023 | Archived- contact OGD Guideline Coordinator for previous versions                                                      |
| Aug 2023          | Minor amendment- ranitidine removed- no longer available                                                               |
| Aug 2025          | Changed format to hyperlink to the National Pregnancy Care guidelines and the WNHS Pregnancy, Birth and your Baby book |

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